

Lewis Robinson

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Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Software Engineer role at Gear4music. I build backend systems for a living: schemas that hold up, service layers that keep their shape, APIs that do one thing well. I also trained as a musician before I came to computing, so a business built around getting instruments into people's hands isn't an abstract pitch to me.

That's part of why Restrum exists: a peer-to-peer instrument marketplace I designed and built solo, live at restrum.uk. Laravel and PHP over MySQL, Elasticsearch for search, Reverb for real-time buyer-seller messaging, and Stripe Connect for split marketplace payments. It's the closest thing I have to a rehearsal for the kind of e-commerce problem you're solving.

Restrum and Seedle both run on that same stack in production. Seedle is a gardening swap and planning platform I built solo in Laravel and PHP 8.4 over MySQL, Elasticsearch and Redis: a REST API with Sanctum auth, service classes for search and checkout, and a claim flow that splits a row-locked database transaction (so nobody claims stock that's already gone) from an async pipeline of queued jobs for notifications and search reindexing, with the queue worker scaling in its own container. 129 PHPUnit tests, Docker Compose, GitHub Actions running PHPUnit and Pint, all on github.com/lewisr23/Seedle.

I work best around people who'll tell me directly when something's wrong, and I try to return the favour. I'd rather find out I'm wrong in a five-minute conversation than three weeks into building the wrong thing.

I'm MSc Computer Science (Distinction, Newcastle University), AWS Developer Associate certified, and I've shipped four projects this year, including a live paid client site handling real member payments. I'd welcome the chance to talk about where I could be useful at Gear4music.

Kind regards,

Lewis Robinson